

dollars.<sup>164</sup> For each 1999 dollar you could buy those 2023 groceries and still have \$3.16 left over.<sup>165</sup>

Hey, that's a very different outcome—if you understand money and math, *you have actually gained purchasing power.*



Every month, traders, TV, investors, and the media eagerly anticipate “the single most important economic data point for your portfolio.” The problem? It's mostly noise...

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<sup>161</sup> Wealth, [instagram.com/p/C0pP4exp3Vx](https://www.instagram.com/p/C0pP4exp3Vx).

<sup>162</sup> Federal Reserve Bank of St Louis, “Employed full time: Median usual weekly nominal earnings.”

<sup>163</sup> Shri Khalpada, “How Far Does \$1 From 1999 Go Today?” PerThirtySix (December 10, 2023).

<sup>164</sup> Nick Maggiulli, “\$1 in the S&P 500 with dividends reinvested grew 6.94% annualized; over that 24-year period it would have grown to \$5.00,” in “S&P 500 Historical Return Calculator [With Dividends],” Of Dollars and Data.

<sup>165</sup> If instead of the S&P 500, you had purchased a conservative 60/40 portfolio of stocks and bonds (e.g., Fidelity Balanced Fund, FBALX) with dividends reinvested, this would have grown at 6.30% annualized. Or, the Vanguard Total Market (VTI) garnered about 7.8% annually over the same period. Data returns from Nick Maggiulli's US Stock/Bond Historical Return Calculator.